

U.S. Government Pressures Anthropic to Suspend Claude Fable and Mythos Models

On June 12, 2026, the artificial intelligence landscape witnessed a historic collision between government regulation and frontier model deployment. Anthropic announced that it was forced to abruptly disable global access to its newly launched models, Claude Fable 5 and Claude Mythos 5. This drastic move followed an export control directive from the U.S. Department of Commerce citing urgent national security concerns.

A Clash of Export Control and AI Safety

The government order mandated that access to Fable 5 and Mythos 5 be suspended for all foreign nationals, regardless of whether they were located inside or outside the United States. The directive reportedly followed a demonstration of a potential "jailbreak" vulnerability in Claude Fable 5, which U.S. officials feared could be exploited by adversaries to identify software vulnerabilities. Because Anthropic could not reliably distinguish the nationality of its users in real time at the API and interface levels, the company chose to globally disable the models to ensure compliance.

Anthropic's Defense of its Safeguards

Anthropic publicly expressed disagreement with the government's action, calling it a misunderstanding. The company stated that the demonstration only identified minor, previously known security vulnerabilities that could also be discovered using other publicly available models. They emphasized that their models are subject to rigorous red-teaming with bodies like the U.S. and UK AI Safety Institutes, and that Fable 5 possessed some of the most robust safeguards ever deployed.

The Outlook: Partial Restoration

The standoff has recently shown signs of resolution. As of late June 2026, the U.S. government authorized Anthropic to restore access to Claude Mythos 5, albeit exclusively for vetted "trusted partners" defending critical infrastructure. However, Claude Fable 5 remains globally disabled as negotiations between the developer and regulators continue. This episode underscores the increasing willingness of governments to actively police the distribution of frontier AI systems.

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